2.4.1 Basic Cuts and Shapes

Cutting food products into uniform shapes and sizes is important for two reasons:

1. It ensures even cooking.
2. It enhances the appearance of the product

Common Vegetable Cuts:

- Brunoise (broon-wahz); Fine dices (3mm × 3mm × 3mm)
  Fine dices are used to make soups, usili and fried rice.

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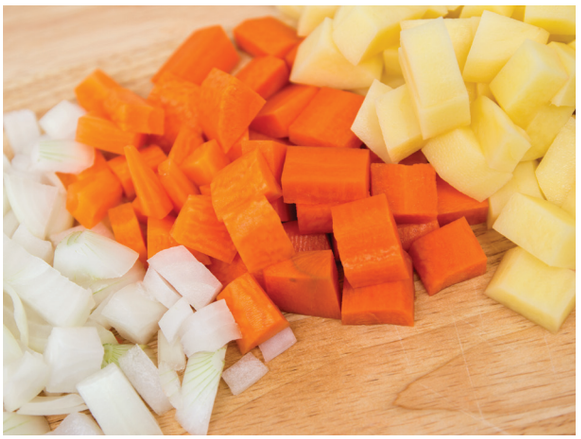


▲ Plate 2.15 Brunoise

- Dicing
  Small dice: (6mm × 6mm × 6mm)
  Medium dice: (12mm × 12mm × 12mm)
  Large dice: (2cm × 2cm × 2cm)

Medium dice are mostly used in the fried items using yam, raw plantain.

Large dice of vegetables are used in the preparation of mourkuzhambu, sambar.



▲ Plate 2.16 Dicing

Julienne (or allumette): (3mm × 3mm × 6cm)

Julienne cuts are used in the preparation of salads and noodles



▲ Plate 2.17 Julienne

- Batonnet: Means little sticks (6mm × 6mm × 6–7.5cm)
  Batonnet cuts are used for making fish fingers.

- French fries or pommefrite: 8–12mm sq × 7.5cm long.

The following terms describe other cutting techniques:

- Chop: to cut into irregular shaped pieces.

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